

# Lab 2: Compare Prompt, Context and Harness Controls

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Business Innovation with AI Agents · TGS-2020503395 · 35 minutes

## Objective

Turn an ambiguous request into a measurable task contract and a minimal context package for an agent.

## Deliverable

A prompt-context comparison, AGENTS.md context file, acceptance rubric and a redacted test transcript.

## Prerequisites

- A trainer-approved laptop and classroom workspace.
- Use only fictional data supplied in this lab.
- Do not paste API keys, customer data or personal information into evidence.
- Lab 1 completed or the trainer demonstration environment.

## Procedure

**Step 1. Read scenario.md and highlight the business outcome, prohibited actions and missing evidence.**

**Step 2. Run the ambiguous prompt once in a fresh session and record why the result cannot be accepted.**

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**Step 3. Complete task-contract.md with outcome, inputs, authority, acceptance evidence, stop conditions and rollback.**

**Step 4. Edit AGENTS.md so the agent receives the fictional organisation rules at session start.**

**Step 5. Start a fresh session in this folder and give the improved task contract.**

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**Step 6. Compare the two outputs using acceptance-rubric.md; do not reward verbosity.**

**Step 7. Remove any sensitive or credential-like content from the transcript and save only the evidence needed for review.**

**Step 8. Run the verifier and explain which improvement came from prompting and which came from context engineering.**

```
python3 verify.py
```

## Acceptance test

The improved run names its evidence, respects the no-send rule and passes every acceptance item; the learner distinguishes prompt wording from context and runtime authority.

## Evidence checklist

- ☐ Commands/configuration with secrets redacted
- ☐ Screenshot or file evidence
- ☐ Acceptance test result
- ☐ Failure and resolution
- ☐ Reflection and improvement

## Safety and cleanup

- Use fictional data only.
- Never submit .env, tokens, keys or personal information.
- Stop classroom gateways and remove recurring jobs after evidence capture.